

Proposed wording for likely and unlikely attributes (Revision 4)

Wording

10.6.N Likelihood attributes [dcl.attr.likelihood]

The *attribute-tokens* **likely** and **unlikely** may be applied to statements. The *attribute-tokens* **likely** and **unlikely** shall appear at most once in each attribute-list and no attribute-argument-clause shall be present. The **likely** attribute is not allowed to appear in the same attribute-list as the **unlikely** attribute.

[Note: The use of the **likely** attribute on a statement is intended to allow implementations to optimize for the case where paths of execution including that statement are arbitrarily more likely than any alternative path of execution that does not include such a statement. The use of the **unlikely** attribute on a statement is intended to allow implementations to optimize for the case where paths of execution including that statement are arbitrarily more unlikely than any alternative path of execution that does not include such a statement. Excessive usage of either of these attributes is liable to result in performance degradation. — *end note*]

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